

ATTRIBUTION METHODOLOGY & THREAT HUNT

THE FINGERPRINT YOU CAN'T ROTATE

Crypto-fraud operators rotate domains faster than any other sector — but they cannot rotate the address that receives the money. By mining **raw page DOM for on-chain and developer-account artifacts**, we clustered otherwise-unconnected incidents into named operators. One wallet tied together **17 competing "prediction market" brands**. Another tied **20 domains** of DAO-governance phishing.

Source: Webamon passive web-scan data 2,500 pages mined 7 operator clusters verified live 2026-08-01

34.6K

domains impersonating wallet & exchange brands

7,856

domains soliciting seed / recovery phrases

17

rival "brands" traced to a single receiving wallet

55

domains attributed into 7 operator clusters

01 THE ATTRIBUTION PROBLEM — AND THE NEW ANSWER

Every conventional web3 indicator is disposable. Domains last weeks. Hosting is behind Cloudflare. Certificates are free and instant. Page kits are copied between unrelated crews. Clustering on any of them produces either noise or nothing.

What we mined instead

Directly from raw page DOM and inline scripts:

Receiving wallet addresses — ETH, TRON, BTC, SOL. The destination of stolen funds.

WalletConnect projectId — a *registered developer identity*.

Infura / Alchemy RPC keys — a registered developer account with billing attached.

Telegram bot & chat IDs — operator-controlled channels.

Why the wallet wins

A domain is a cost of doing business — burn it, buy another. The receiving address is **the business itself**. Changing it means re-deploying every page, updating every contract approval flow, and losing funds already in flight.

Operators rotate the disposable layer aggressively and leave the wallet in place. That asymmetry is what makes the clustering work.

The method's critical caveat — and it is not optional. Scam pages embed the *canonical* contract addresses of the tokens they intend to steal: USDT, USDC, WETH and the major DEX routers. Those appear on dozens of unrelated scam sites because they are the **targets**, not the operators. Clustering on them merges the entire ecosystem into one meaningless blob. Our first pass did exactly that — the fix is an explicit canonical-contract exclusion list, applied before any clustering.

02 OPERATOR CLUSTER 1 — THE PREDICTION-MARKET FACTORY

Seventeen domains presenting as **seventeen competing prediction-market platforms**, each with its own branding, all funnelling to a **single Ethereum address**.

easyup[.]lat · exmarket[.]wtf · forelytic[.]com · franticmarket[.]com
oddsly[.]fun · oraculus[.]bet · oraculus[.]live · poly-market[.]top
polydexy[.]com · polyfucked[.]top · **polynarket[.]vip** · predentra[.]com
predictbase[.]site · predimate[.]com · predivo[.]trade · predxmarket[.]xyz
wagerpoly[.]com

The tell inside the tell

`polynarket[.]vip` uses an **rn → m homoglyph**: at small sizes "rn" is visually indistinguishable from "m", rendering as *polymarket*.

Several others — `poly-market`, `polydexy`, `wagerpoly` — orbit the same real brand, while the remainder present as entirely independent platforms. Without the wallet link, an analyst would log these as a dozen separate incidents.

Cluster profile

Anchor	eth 0x2d71435b...a166d0
Domains	17
Active	2026-05-20 → 07-09
TLDs	.com .top .bet .fun .lat .live .vip .wtf

A deliberately diversified brand portfolio — the opposite of the single-brand fleets seen in banking fraud.

03 OPERATOR CLUSTER 2 — DAO GOVERNANCE PHISHING

Twenty domains built around **fake governance votes and proposals** — an attack aimed squarely at engaged DeFi holders, who expect to sign transactions to participate.

vote-alturas[.]xyz · votes-onyx[.]app · voted-onyx[.]com · onyx-votes[.]xyz
proposal-onyx[.]com · governances-onyx[.]com · governances-onyx[.]xyz
reward-onyx[.]xyz · rewards-onyx[.]xyz · updates-onyx[.]org · xcn-onyx[.]org
onyxfoundation[.]xyz · kryptoswap[.]org · mexccard[.]com · acrosstochains[.]com

Why governance is the perfect lure

Voting on a DAO proposal **legitimately requires a wallet signature**. The victim is not being tricked into an unusual action — they are doing exactly what participation normally looks like. The malicious approval hides inside an expected workflow.

Lure vocabulary is systematic: `vote-`, `votes-`, `voted-`, `proposal-`, `governances-`, `rewards-`, `updates-`.

It does not stay on one protocol

The same wallet appears on `vote-alturas[.]xyz` — a **different protocol entirely** — plus a crypto-swap brand, an exchange-card brand and a cross-chain bridge brand.

One operator, many victim communities. Any single protocol's security team would see only their own slice; the wallet exposes the whole operation.

04

THE DEVELOPER-IDENTITY LAYER

The most novel finding. Wallets cluster incidents that share a *payout*. Developer-account artifacts cluster incidents that share a **builder** — and they cut across brand themes where wallets do not.

ARTIFACT TYPE	VALUE	LINKS TOGETHER	WHY IT ATTRIBUTES
WalletConnect projectId	605ee035...d0bdb	verify-trust[.]app verify-wallet[.]app	One registered developer account — despite the pages impersonating <i>two different brands</i> (Trust Wallet and Etherscan)
Infura RPC key	2396d7d8...12c	cipherark[.]net safeguardx[.]net	A billed API key tied to a real account, reused across two "wallet" brands
Alchemy API key	3TmVfhVAJBbemZb3rLkn m	mariantracker[.]site robobridge[.]online	Same, across a token-tracker and a bridge brand
Multi-chain wallet set	eth 0x8566F831...15Abd + 2 TRON addresses	8 AlphaPepe presale domains	Same operator collecting on two chains simultaneously

Why this matters beyond detection. A domain registration is anonymous. A WalletConnect project, an Infura key and an Alchemy key are **registered accounts with a provider** — created with an email, and in the paid tiers, a payment method. These artifacts are therefore not just clustering keys; they are the point at which an investigation can leave the open web and become a formal request to a named company.

The web3 abuse surface, 2026 YTD



Heavy concentration on free developer hosting (.dev / .app) — deploy cost is effectively zero.

Attributed clusters

CLUSTER	DOMAINS	ANCHOR
Onyx governance phishing	20	ETH wallet
Prediction-market factory	17	ETH wallet
USDT approval drain	8	ETH wallet
AlphaPepe presale	8	ETH + 2× TRON
Wallet-verification pair	2	WalletConnect ID
Cipher / SafeguardX	2	Infura key
Trust Wallet "AML service"	2	TRON wallet

Verified live on 2026-08-01: 30 of 55 still hosting.

FOR THREAT TEAMS

1. **Extract wallet addresses at scan time** and treat them as first-class IOCs. They outlive every domain in the campaign.
2. **Maintain a canonical-contract exclusion list** — USDT, USDC, WETH, DEX routers. Without it, wallet clustering is worthless.
3. **Pivot on developer-account artifacts** — WalletConnect projectId, Infura and Alchemy keys. They attribute across brand themes that wallets cannot.

FOR PROTOCOLS & EXCHANGES

1. **Your governance flow is an attack surface.** Fake proposal and voting pages exploit the fact that signing is the legitimate user action.
2. **Watch adjacent protocols.** The operator draining your holders is running the same wallet against other communities — shared intelligence exposes it faster than solo monitoring.
3. **Monitor homoglyphs**, notably `rn` → `m`, which defeats visual review.

FOR INVESTIGATORS

1. **Developer artifacts are a legal pivot.** Unlike a domain, a WalletConnect or Infura account maps to a provider record — a subpoena target rather than a dead end.
2. **Chase multi-chain sets.** Operators collecting on ETH and TRON simultaneously reveal a broader footprint than any single chain shows.